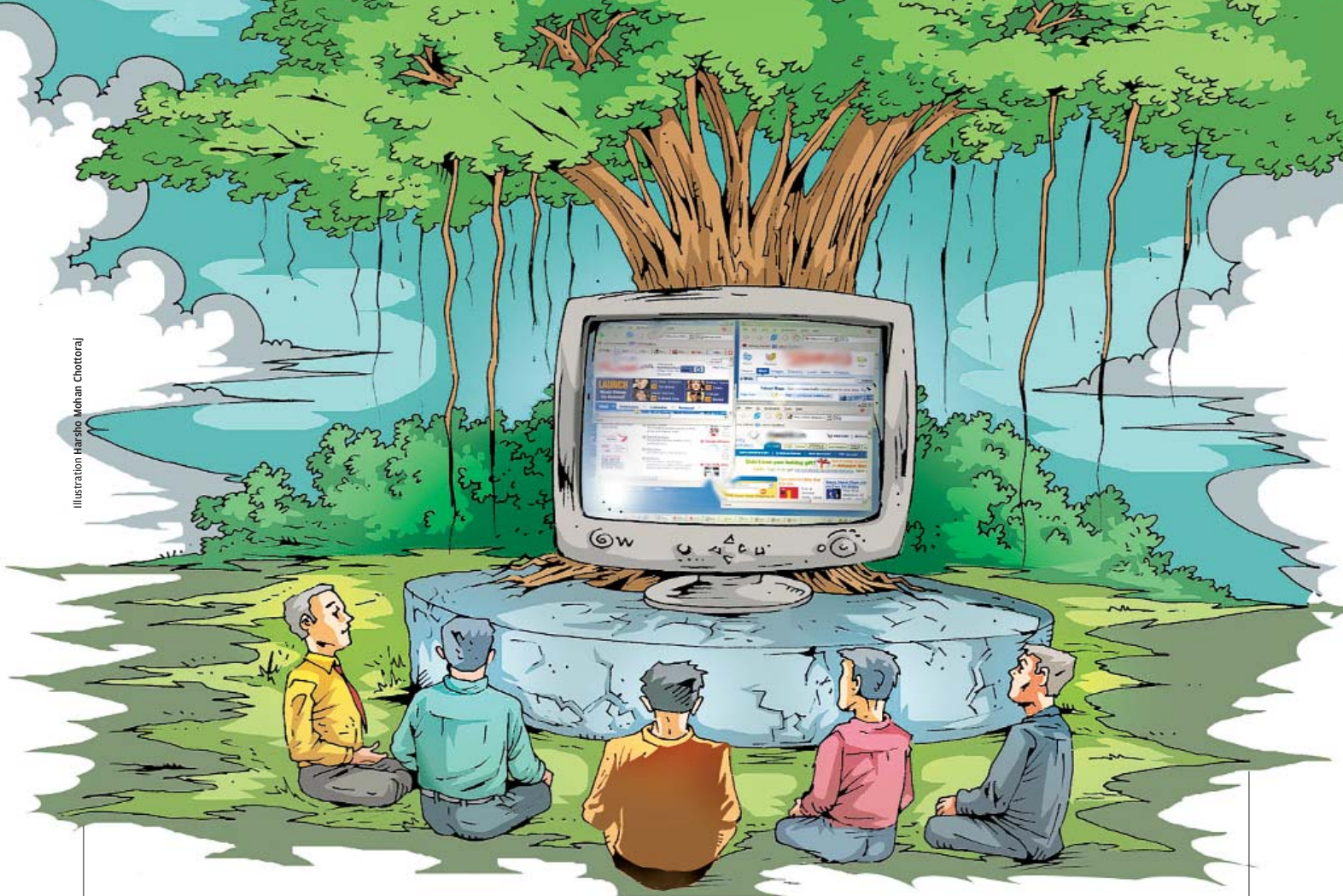




Upgrade Your Skill Set

So you are high-flier at your workplace? Never mind your achievements; get set to acquire a whole new range of soft skills with these Web sites

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If you are an employer, you need soft skills. If you are an employee, you need soft skills too. In fact, whoever you are, at whatever level in your organisation, it's your soft skills that consistently matter—an area of development you are most likely to ignore.

At http://snipurl.com/digit_skills1 is a 'Soft Skills Quiz' that tests your soft skills quotient. The page lists the 25 "Most frequently cited soft skills". Some of these include oral / spoken communication skills, honesty, team work or collaboration skills, self-motivation/initiative, leadership skills, 'Working under pressure', creativity, and time management skills.

According to job portal monster.com, employers consistently look for soft skills. You may not have several of these traits and skills, but you can easily and actively pursue developing these skills online. Of course, it's probably not possible to take a course on, say, 'honesty' but there are several areas where you and members of your organisation can actively improve.

From certmag.com, here's an 'Unofficial list of soft skills for techies'—

- ☐ Team work
- ☐ Communication skills
- ☐ Presentation skills
- ☐ Selling
- ☐ Running meetings
- ☐ Leadership
- ☐ Problem solving
- ☐ Customer service

Let's look at some Web sites that can help you and your employees develop these essential soft skills.

Brownbag Training www.brownbagtraining.com

Brown Bag Training is an e-learning site that delivers classes online. Classes are presented live by an instructor. There are a variety of soft skill classes to choose from and a variety of "Class Packs" are available. A 20-pack costs \$1,049 (Rs 49,000). But you could choose a single class for \$59 (Rs 2,700). They offer a satisfaction promise—if you are not satisfied with the class or classes you receive, you get all your money back.

Using the Brown Bag development process, they will custom-develop a class or series of classes